

ENCLAVE

CHRONICLES

EPISODE 8

THE WEIGHT OF THE WORLD

→ SOME ANCHORS ARE MEANT TO FALL ←





THE GRAVITY SPIKE HIT
BEFORE THE WARNING.
ZERO TO CRUSH IN
ONE IMPOSSIBLE BREATH.



THE REEFS BREAK
UPWARD AND DOWN.



THERE IS NO
UP ANYMORE.



ANCHOR LINE
HOLDING--BARELY!

KEEP YOUR
WEIGHT LOW,
RENN!

IT'S GETTING
FASTER--!

TICK!
TICK!
TICK!



KRRR
RAAAK

EVERY IMPACT
SENDS SHOCK THROUGH
THE WHOLE REEF.



DOWN IS A
PLACE THAT
NEVER ENDS.



HEH...
GUESS WE'RE
FINDING OUT.

AND WE'RE
RUNNING OUT OF
THINGS LEFT TO
HOLD ON TO.



...THERE IS
NOWHERE
TO MOVE.

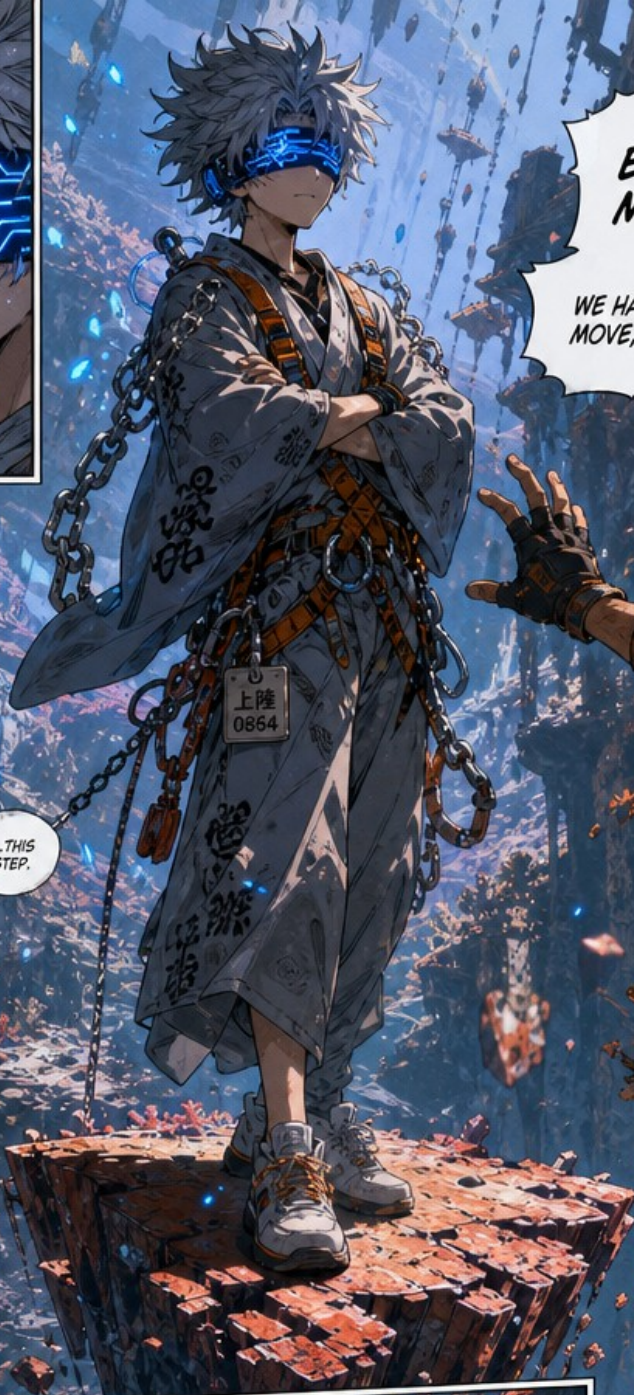
THERE IS
ONLY...



...THIS
STEP.

STILLNESS
ISN'T ESCAPE.

IT'S
ANCHOR.



ECHO!
MOVE!

WE HAVE TO
MOVE, NOW!



TREMBLE

TREMBLE

YOU DON'T
GET IT!

THIS THING IS
FALLING APART!

WE'RE ALL
GONNA—



SNAP!



SHATTER!



CORAL SPIRE
DELTA-7... COLLAPSE
CONFIRMED!

STARBOARD
BALAST TANK
RUPTURED!

TENSION
LINE AT 98%!

HA!
STILL HOLDS...
...FOR NOW.

HOLD
THE LINE.
WE DON'T FALL
TODAY.

RENN. SIXTEEN.
SLOANE. SIXTEEN.
BIX. FOURTEEN.
**WE CLIMB.
WE HOLD.
WE ENDURE.**

SPIRAL
CLIMBERS
GUILD

PORT REEF
COLUMN SHEARED!

DECK ANGLE
THIRTY-SEVEN
DEGREES!

BIO-LUMINESCENT
FRAGMENTS—
EVERYWHERE!



VANGUARD
DROP-TROOPERS.



DISCIPLINE.
PRECISION.
PURPOSE.



TETHER-
LINES
SECURE.



CORAL CANOPY
SHATTERING.



VISUAL CONTACT
WITH TARGET.



WE DESCEND.



THE ANCHORED
AIRSHIP.

OUR OBJECTIVE.

OUR MOMENT.



IN POSITION.



ON MY
MARK...

WE TAKE HOLD.



VANGUARD
FIRST TO FALL.
FIRST TO STAND.



SLOANE.
SIXTEEN.

VANGUARD CADET.
RANK INSIGNIA
REMOVED.

THEY WANT
OBEDIENCE.

THEY'LL HAVE
TO TAKE IT.

ANCHORITE
VANGUARD
DROP-TROOPERS.

DISCIPLINE.
PRECISION.

PURGING
DISSENT.

KLANG

THEIR CAUSE
ISN'T WRONG.

THEIR METHODS
AREN'T EITHER.
NOT TO THEM.

CHNK

KREEE

I USED TO
BELIEVE THAT
WAS ENOUGH.

NOW I KNOW
BETTER.

PRINCIPLES
MEAN NOTHING
IF YOU ABANDON
YOUR OWN.

CADET SLOANE.
YOU ARE ORDERED
TO SURRENDER
YOUR WEAPON.

YOU WILL
BE ESCORTED
TO COMMAND.

NOT
A CHANCE.

VANGUARD
TACTICAL MANUAL,
SECTION 7, ARTICLE 12:

"MAINTAIN FORMATION.
MAINTAIN DISCIPLINE.
VICTORY FOLLOWS
ORDER."

THEY DRILL IT
INTO US UNTIL
WE BREATHE IT.

TODAY,
I STOP
BREATHING.

CADET
SLOANE!

REJOIN
FORMATION
AT ONCE!

ORDER
ISN'T STRENGTH.
ADAPTATION IS.

THEY TEACH
US HOW TO
FOLLOW.

NO ONE
TEACHES YOU
WHEN TO
BREAK.

SKRRRRCH

TWO HEARTS.
ONE RHYTHM.
ONE OPENING.

THAT'S ALL.

THAT'S
ENOUGH.

THE INSTANT
ORDER FAILS—

I WIN.

CHAPTER 7
FATHOMS BELOW,
COURSE UNKNOWN'

INCOMING!

BEARING
ZERO-THREE-TWO!
CLOSING FAST!

KZZT!

VRRR~

SWEEP

NOT
MAKING
COURSE!

ALL HANDS!
BRACE FOR
IMPACT!

BIX
FOURTEEN.
NAVIGATOR ADEPT.
ALWAYS COUNTS
THE TICKS.

RANGE: 2.4 KM
T.T.A.: 00:00:28

VECTOR LOCK

TWENTY
SECONDS!

STEER NOW
OR WE DON'T
SURVIVE THE
DROP!

A VANGUARD
CADET DOES NOT
FLINCH.

A VANGUARD
CADET ADAPTS.

A VANGUARD
CADET SURVIVES.

部

SLOANE—
DOWN!

PLUMB-ANCHOR
PATTERN: HOLLOW DAWN
MASS: 3,812 LBS
VELOCITY: 83 KNOTS
IMPACT ZONE: CORAL PLATFORM
BREACH DEPTH: 6.4 METERS

部

ONE HEARTBEAT.
THAT IS ALL.

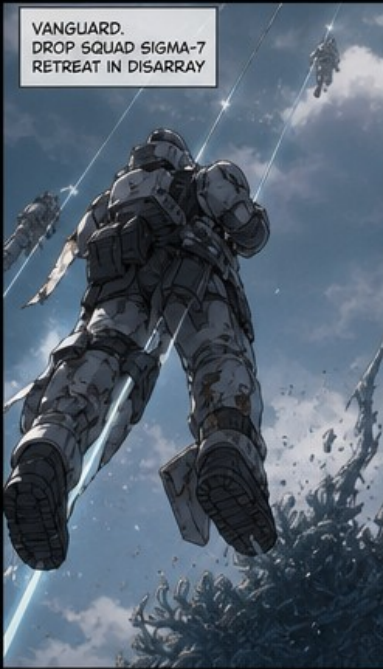
BETWEEN DUTY
AND DISASTER—

—STANDS
A VOICE.

NERVOUS.
BRILLIANT.
IRREPLACEABLE.

THAT IS BIX.

THAT IS WHY
SLOANE LIVES.



VANGUARD.
DROP SQUAD SIGMA-7
RETREAT IN DISARRAY



...LAST TETHER
STILL HOLDING...



—SNAP—



...LAST
SQUAD
GONE.



SLOANE.
SIXTEEN.



VANGUARD CADET.
STRIPPED OF RANK.

LAST ON DECK.

BREATHING HARD.
UNBROKEN.

THE REEF FALLS.
THE ORDER RETREATS.
SLOANE REMAINS.

The Briar-Reef is falling.

Defeated troopers.
Broken anchors.
No altitude.
No mercy.

Just gravity,
and whatever waits
at the bottom
of this storm.



KRRRREERRRR—





WEAVER'S
THIMBLE.

THREE-BAND
STAR-BRASS.
NO LATCH.
NO MERCY.



RENN-
DON'T!

YOU CAN'T
MEAN TO—!



R-R-R-RENN...
THE DECK'S
AT A 37° TILT
AND CLIMBING!

IF YOU CUT
THE LOAD—



I'M
NOT CUTTING
THE LOAD.

I'M GIVING
IT A PATH.

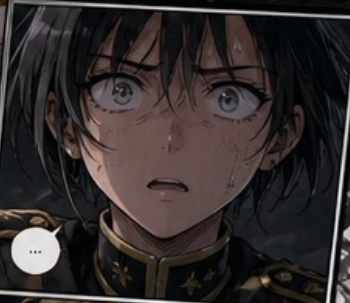
YOU'LL
KILL US
ALL!



TRUST
THE WEAVE,
SLOANE.

OR
TRUST ME.

YOUR CHOICE.



THE DECK
DOESN'T CARE
WHO'S RIGHT.

IT CARES
WHO LETS GO
FIRST.



Renn.
Sixteen.
Professional
problem
maker.

Today's plan:
Dive headfirst into
a falling reef.
Smart.



Scared?
Yeah.
Worth it?
Always.



K-CHK

Tension-Gauntlet
spooled.
Pray it holds.



Weaver's
Thimble—
online.

Let there
be a damn
thread to
anything.



If I'm going
down—
I'm taking
something
with me.



Plumb-Anchors.
Seven.
All going down.
All the way.

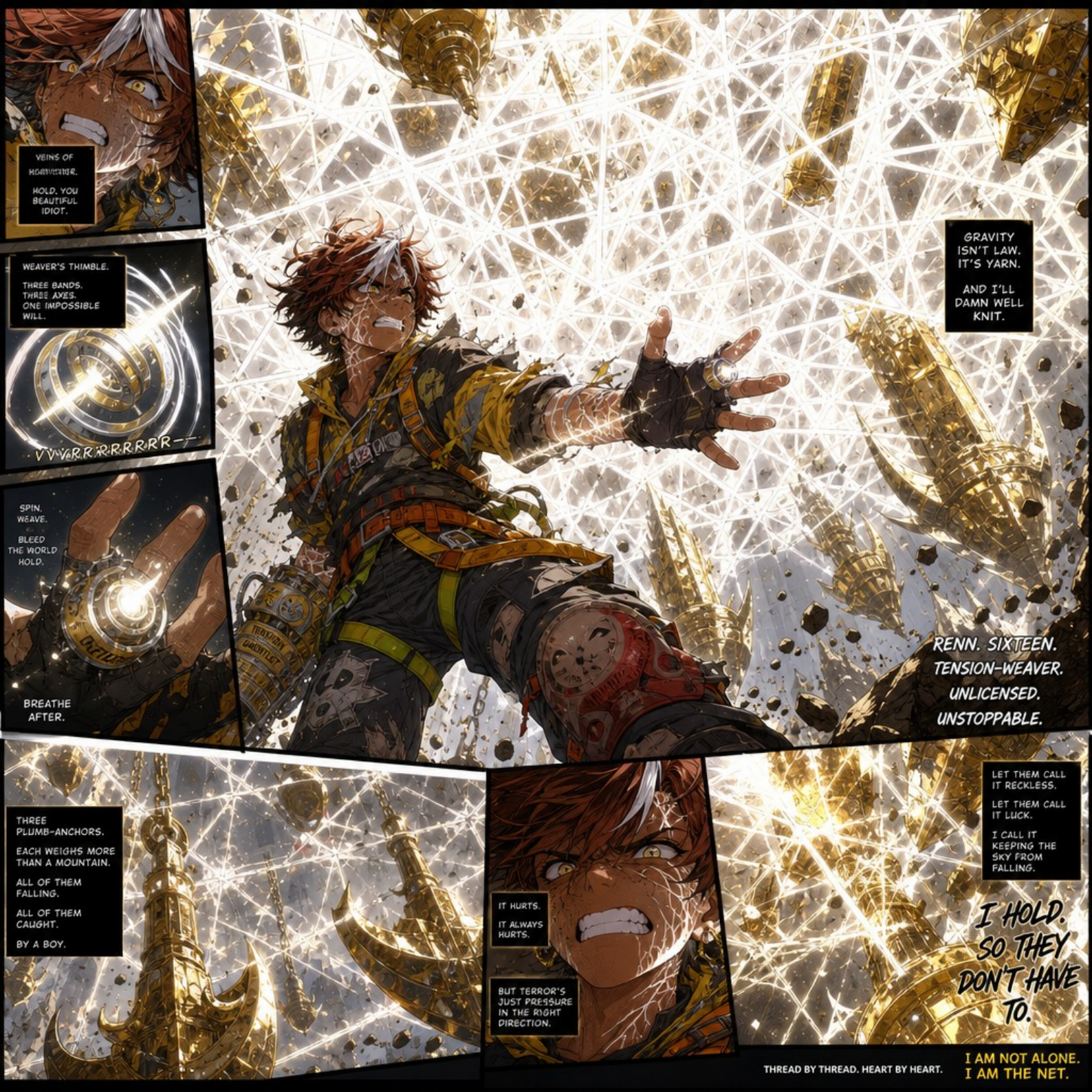
Reef's
collapsing.
The old ways
don't anchor
here.

Time to
weave a new
one.

Don't think.
Don't flinch.
Thread.
Tension.
Tie it
together.

NOW.

**DIVE.
WEAVE.
SURVIVE.**



VEINS OF
HOLDWEAVER.
HOLD. YOU
BEAUTIFUL
IDIOT.

WEAVER'S THIMBLE.
THREE BANDS.
THREE AVES.
ONE IMPOSSIBLE
WILL.

GRAVITY
ISN'T LAW.
IT'S YARN.
AND I'LL
DAMN WELL
KNIT.

SPIN.
WEAVE.
BLEED
THE WORLD
HOLD.

BREATHE
AFTER.

RENN. SIXTEEN.
TENSION-WEAVER.
UNLICENSED.
UNSTOPPABLE.

THREE
PLUMB-ANCHORS.
EACH WEIGHS MORE
THAN A MOUNTAIN.
ALL OF THEM
FALLING.
ALL OF THEM
CAUGHT.
BY A BOY.

IT HURTS.
IT ALWAYS
HURTS.

BUT TERROR'S
JUST PRESSURE
IN THE RIGHT
DIRECTION.

LET THEM CALL
IT RECKLESS.
LET THEM CALL
IT LUCK.
I CALL IT
KEEPING THE
SKY FROM
FALLING.

*I HOLD.
SO THEY
DON'T HAVE
TO.*

THREAD BY THREAD. HEART BY HEART.

I AM NOT ALONE.
I AM THE NET.

THE BRIAR-REEF
WAS FALLING.

THEN—

—THE GRAVITY-THREAD
SNAPPED INTO PLACE.

AND EVERYTHING
STOOD STILL.

KRAAANG!

R-RENN?!

TREMBLE

TREMBLE

NO...!

RENN—

A NET OF LIGHT.

WOVEN FROM
GRAVITY ITSELF.

EVERY THREAD,
PULLED TIGHT.

EVERY FALL,
DENIED.

THE SPOOL
UNWOUND.

THE TENSION
RELEASED.

THE BOY
LET GO.

AND THE
WORLD...

HELD ITS
BREATH.

BRIAR-REEF
SUSPENDED.

RENN

AGE: 16
CLIMBER // TETHERHAND
TENSION-GAUNTLET MK.II
STATUS: UNCONSCIOUS

She was
the tether.

He was
the drift.

Between them—
only the fall.

SLOANE
VANGUARD CADET
AGE: 16

Duty said
hold the line.

Heart said
jump.

And so—
she fell.

Not for glory.

For him.

PREPARE THE
TETHER NET.

LEAVE THEM
ENOUGH HOPE
TO REACH.

THEN—
RETRIEVE.

AS YOU
COMMAND,
LORD-WARDEN.

LORD-WARDEN VALERIUS
VANGUARD SUPREME COMMAND
DREADNOUGHT ALETHEIA